How large is the faculty at each IISER and IISc, and does size explain IISER Kolkata's low share of women?

Source: NIRF "Overall" faculty tables, latest list for each institute (2025 or 2026). Regular faculty only. Intervals are 95% Wilson intervals.

Institute	Faculty	Women	Share	95% interval	One person moves the share by
IISc	482	48	10.0%	7.6–13.0%	0.2 points
IISER Bhopal	174	35	20.1%	14.8–26.7%	0.6 points
IISER Pune	142	31	21.8%	15.8–29.3%	0.7 points
IISER Kolkata	**125**	**18**	**14.4%**	**9.3–21.6%**	**0.8 points**
IISER Mohali	115	20	17.4%	11.5–25.3%	0.9 points
IISER Thiruvananthapuram	113	22	19.5%	13.2–27.7%	0.9 points
IISER Tirupati	69	16	23.2%	14.8–34.4%	1.5 points
IISER Berhampur	50	6	12.0%	5.6–23.8%	2.0 points

What this shows

- **Kolkata is not small.** With 125 regular faculty it is the third-largest of the seven IISERs, after Bhopal (174) and Pune (142). IISc has 482.
- **Small numbers make shares jumpy at other institutes, not at Kolkata.** At Tirupati and Berhampur one hire or exit moves the share by 1.5 to 2 points; at Kolkata it moves it by 0.8.
- **Kolkata's share has been steady.** It stayed between 13.8% and 14.4% across eight NIRF lists since 2019, while faculty grew from 108 to 125 and women from 15 to 18.
- **The intervals are wide everywhere except IISc.** Kolkata's runs from 9.3% to 21.6%, so small differences between IISERs should not be read as real.

What this changes in our claims

The other six IISERs pooled are 19.6% women (130 of 663). Kolkata's 14.4% is lower, but with 125 faculty we cannot rule out chance ($p = 0.21$, Fisher's exact test). The same is true against IISc (10.0%; $p = 0.20$). What the data do support:

- Kolkata is below the average for all Institutes of National Importance (22.1%); $p \approx 0.04$, borderline.

- Kolkata is far below the national figure of 44.9%.
- At Kolkata the share of women among faculty (14.4%) is about 13 points below their share among UG students (27.2%), and it has not moved in seven years.

IISER Kolkata has 125 regular faculty, 18 of them women (14.4%). This is lower than the 19.6% at the other six IISERs together, but with numbers this small we cannot say the difference is more than chance. It is below the 22.1% average for Institutes of National Importance and well below the 44.9% for India, and it has stayed between 13.8% and 14.4% since 2019.